

What happened four days ago?

I was getting hurt on a trade and released some aggression.

How often do you lose your temper?

Much less than I used to because the playing field has become level. Originally, my anger stemmed from my not being able to handle being ripped off and lied to. Before electronic trading, it used to be almost every day and sometimes even multiple times a day. When I was working for Spear Leeds, people could hear me on the other floor. That's how loud I was.

Who were you yelling at?

The brokers.

[An assistant brings in lunch, and Benedict addresses the question to him.] Do I have a bad temper?

[Assistant speaking] The evidence is over there. [He points to a broken phone on the floor.] We have stacks of broken phones.

Do you buy them in gross?

[Benedict speaking] At Spear Leeds, they actually charged my account for broken phones. They subtracted it from my P&L [he laughs]. I've gotten a lot better over the years, but I used to be very bad. [Benedict calls another friend on the speakerphone.] Do I have a bad temper?

[There is a 20-second laugh before the voice on the speakerphone replies.] You are a great guy, but you definitely have a dark side.

[Benedict] How dark?

[Friend] We don't want to go there. Put it this way, I wouldn't want to be on the other side of your wrath. Many phones have not survived you.

I understand that you worked for Marty Schwartz.² How did that come about?

I was at Spear Leeds at the time. I was trading the S&P 500 and getting a reputation of doing fairly well. Marty Schwartz was in the process of moving from New York to Florida and solicited me to come work for him. I knew of Marty from your book *Market Wizards* and thought it would be a privilege to work for him. I went to my boss, Peter Kellogg,